

VulnHub is an open source, continually updated catalogue of IT assets, which are legally hackable, breakable, and exploitable by design. It added that the



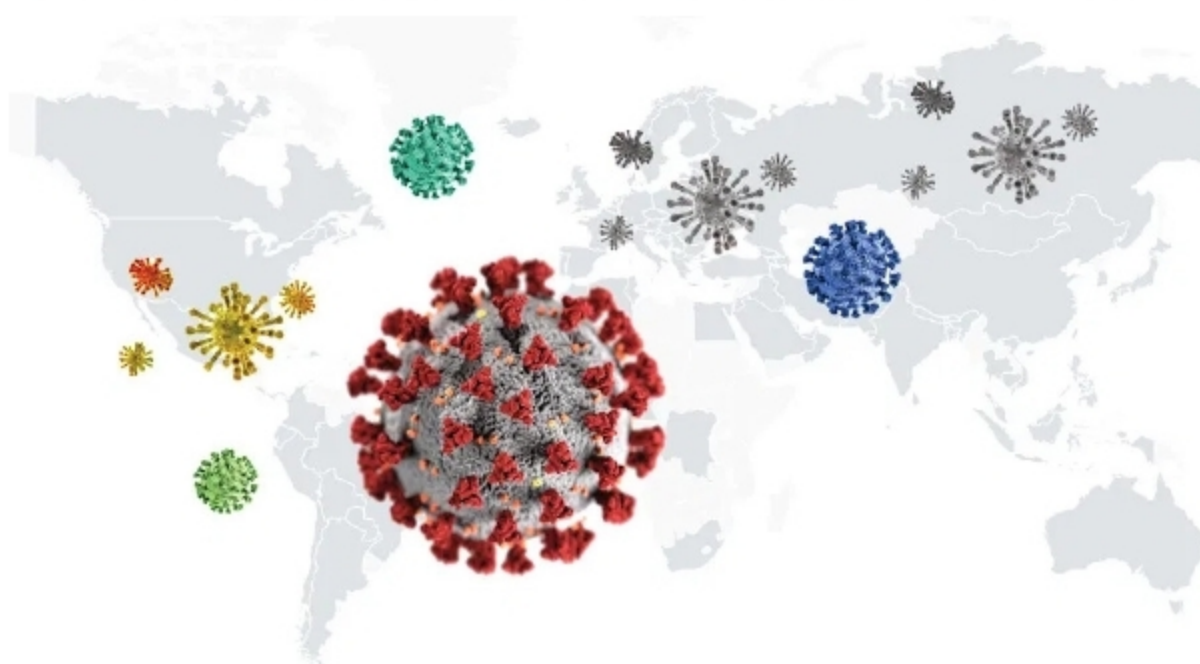
catalogue will help security and IT professionals to try their hand at penetration testing in a safe, controlled environment.

All VulnHub content will remain available for free. OffSec also provides other open source tools designed to help security

professionals gain hands-on experience, including Kali Linux, Exploit DB, and Metasploit.

The Linux Foundation launches Linux Foundation Public Health initiative to combat COVID-19

The Linux Foundation has launched a Linux Foundation Public Health (LFPH) initiative to help public health authorities (PHAs) around the world combat COVID-19 and future epidemics. The initiative is driven by seven members —Cisco, doc.ai, Geometer, IBM, NearForm, Tencent, and VMware — and two hosted exposure notification projects, COVID Shield and COVID Green, which are presently being deployed in Canada, Ireland, and several states in the US.



Dan Kohn, LFPH general manager, said, “To catalyse this open source development, Linux Foundation Public Health is building a global community of leading technology and consulting companies, public health authorities, epidemiologists and other public health specialists, privacy and security experts, and individual developers. While we are excited to launch with two very important open source projects, we think our convening function to enable collaboration to battle this pandemic may be our biggest impact.”

COVID Shield was developed by a volunteer team at Shopify and is in the process of being deployed in Canada. COVID Green was developed by a team at NearForm as part of the Irish government’s response to COVID-19. It has received a high adoption of over one-third of the country’s adults since being deployed by Ireland’s Health Services Executive.

Along with COVID Shield and COVID Green, an earlier cross-industry collaboration effort, the TCN Coalition, is merging into LFPH. This is a global community of technologists supporting the development of privacy-preserving and cross-compatible exposure notification apps during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Updates to Puppet Enterprise announced

Puppet, the industry standard for infrastructure automation, has announced updates to Puppet Enterprise that will make it easier and faster to automate complex infrastructure operations, as per the company. This will provide improved application deployments, fewer errors and disruptions, and greater operational repeatability and efficiency.

The company said that, with this release, customers will be able to use the thousands of open source and Puppet-built modules available on Puppet Forge as building blocks to quickly compose and manage plans through the Puppet Enterprise console. It added that Platform, DevOps and other teams will be able to expand automation into more far-reaching infrastructure use cases. This can be done by mixing and matching imperative tasks with declarative model based automation, with enterprise-grade visibility and control.

Abby Kearns, Puppet CTO, said, “Application deployments are increasingly waiting on DevOps and platform teams to carry out complex sequences of infrastructure configuration, which, when done manually, also increases the risk of errors and disruption. These teams start off making fast progress with basic automation tools, but hit a roadblock once requirements become more complex. Puppet now provides a growth path from the fast start of Puppet Bolt and Puppet Forge content to powerful orchestration workflows, to deliver on our promise of continuous automation.”

Puppet Enterprise will also include an upgrade pre-check module. It will perform a readiness assessment and identify potential risks, and what changes are needed before running an upgrade.